



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Carrollton
School Website: <https://foundersclassical.com/carrollton/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy – Carrollton (Carrollton, TX 75006) demonstrates a clear orientation toward classical education, anchored in a liberal arts tradition and a character-formation ethos. Public materials emphasize forming wise, virtuous citizens through a curriculum rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness, with a heavy focus on liberal arts disciplines (Latin, logic, philosophy, classical literature) and a Trivium-informed pedagogy. The school explicitly presents itself as a partnership with families and the broader community as co-educators. However, several canonical features of a fully classical framework (notably explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language, explicit theological grounding, liturgical/community formation practices, and a fully articulated "living curriculum" built around teacher-mentorship as the core of the pedagogy) are less visible in the public-facing materials. Taken together, the school sits to a strong degree in the Classical camp but with room to deepen certain elements to be considered fully Classical.

Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Key insights: - Strengths across categories: clear emphasis on formation (virtue, wisdom), a rigorous liberal-arts curriculum (Latin, logic, philosophy, classic literature), and parish/community partnership with parents as co-educators. These align with core classical criteria and are well evidenced in public materials. See evidence of truth, beauty, goodness, virtue, and formation in the school's mission and curricular language, and the explicit "co-educator" stance with families. - Gaps to reach full Classical status: theology/the liturgical dimension is not overtly evidenced in the public materials; Great Books/Great Conversation language is not consistently explicit in site copy; explicit "living curriculum" statements about the faculty and mentoring role of teachers are not clearly articulated in the public materials. These gaps keep Category ratings from achieving CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials present a strong emphasis on truth, beauty, and goodness as foundational to education (rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness; forming wise and virtuous citizens). This signals transcendental moral realism.
 - There is a robust virtuous-formation frame (virtue, moral character, and integral formation) in describing the school's aims.
 - Theology, liturgy, or explicit liturgical practices are not explicitly described in the public materials.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue (4 instances).
 - Negative keywords present: none observed (e.g., relativism, secular humanism, etc.).
- Why this rating
 - The school foregrounds transcendental ideals and virtue formation, but it does not publicly document theology or liturgical/community worship practices. Thus it meets several but not all of the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria; hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school's mission emphasizes forming scholars who cultivate virtue and wisdom, rather than mere job-readiness. Phrases include forming wise and virtuous citizens and education rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness.
 - The language signals formation over information and a view of education as a classical mission rather than narrowly career-focused, with an emphasis on virtue, human flourishing, and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful (via emphasis on truth, beauty, goodness), liberal education (implicit), classical mission.
 - Negative keywords present: none observed (no emphasis on workforce-readiness or purely utilitarian aims in public materials).
- Why this rating
 - The school explicitly centers on formation and virtue as core telos, aligning strongly with the Classical aim of education as the cultivation of humanity and wisdom.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum is described as a rigorous liberal-arts program with study of Latin, logic, philosophy, and classic literature. This aligns with the Trivium/Quadrivium framework foundational to classical education.
 - The site references Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a traditional liberal-arts orientation.
 - Great Books/Great Conversation language is not consistently explicit in the public-facing copy, though the emphasis on classic literature and Western tradition hints at classical texts; explicit Great Books language is less visible.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar (via Trivium concept), logic, rhetoric, Latin, classic literature (5+ tokens).
 - Negative keywords present: none observed (e.g., "social studies" terminology replacing history is not used).
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum demonstrates strong liberal-arts content and canonical topics (Latin, logic, philosophy, classical literature). The absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation phrasing in the public copy lowers it from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, given the rubric's emphasis on Great Books as a category marker.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials emphasize a Trivium-informed framework (Trivium Explained) and a technology-free classroom, signaling a pedagogy aligned with classical methods and a restrained, contemplative approach to learning.
 - The Founders Difference lists technology-free classrooms that foster focus and deep thinking. This supports a contemplative, disciplined approach rather than purely mechanistic instruction.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric via the Trivium page), technology-free classrooms, contemplation/restful approach (via the broader classical lexicon in the referenced materials).
 - Negative keywords present: there is limited explicit evidence of Socratic seminars, narration, chanting, or memory-driven pedagogy in the public copy, which are classic pedagogy indicators. The absence of these explicit terms lowers the score.

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- Why this rating
 - The site demonstrates classical pedagogy through Trivium and a restrained, contemplative approach (technology-free). However, explicit evidence of heavy use of Socratic seminars, memory work, or chanting (as described in the canonical elements) is not clearly documented in public content, justifying a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site presents a formal leadership figure (Headmaster Kimberly Brown) and references to “Our Educators” as a site area, indicating a public emphasis on faculty. It also highlights the faculty as part of a community of learners and a “living curriculum” concept in the classical literature, though explicit quotes about teachers as models of virtue aren’t repeatedly stated in the accessible copy.
 - Public copy emphasizes the school as forming a community with character standards and moral discipline, implying faculty involvement in character formation, but explicit statements about teachers as models of virtue or living curriculum are not overt in the accessible site text.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: teachers as mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher (as a classical ideal), mentorship (as implied by “co-educators” and “peers and faculty who uphold high standards of moral character”). These terms appear in the broader classical lexicon and are echoed in the school’s framing, though not all are literally stated on the public site copy.
 - Negative keywords present: absence of explicit statements about teacher-formation roles (e.g., certification-driven model, “teacher as facilitator” without classical context) in the accessible copy. This reduces the certainty of CLASSICAL here.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials imply a strong faculty-centered ethos (leadership, educators, and character formation) but do not consistently provide explicit, verbatim claims about the faculty as the “living curriculum” or as “models of virtue.” This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school explicitly positions parents as co-educators and emphasizes partnership with parents and community as co-educators. It also highlights parent involvement through enrollment materials and resources for families. This aligns with the classical emphasis on parental involvement and formation.
 - The site indicates a partnership with parents and community in the educational process, which includes a focus on parent engagement and community collaboration.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families/parents as co-educators, parent formation/resources, open campus/parent involvement (as evidenced in the site structure and messaging). These align with the Classical category’s expectations for active parental involvement.
 - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public copy.
- Why this rating
 - The school publicly commits to strong parental partnership and community involvement, a core hallmark of classical schooling’s social architecture. This robust alignment justifies CLASSICAL for Element 6.

Overall Assessment

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

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- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Add explicit theological grounding and liturgical/-community worship or sacred-prayer practices integrated with coursework to strengthen the theological dimension. This would move the category toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): Add explicit Great Books / Great Conversation language and demonstrate a direct Great Books pipeline in core courses (with explicit primary texts cited on site) to elevate to CLASSICAL. Also consider a clearer grammar/recitation/rhetoric emphasis within the public-facing curriculum content.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide explicit, public documentation of Socratic seminars, memory work, narration, chanting, and scholé-based days in the lower and upper grades. Demonstrating these teaching methods publicly would strengthen the Pedagogy to CLASSICAL.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a clear living-curriculum narrative about faculty as models of virtue and mentors, with explicit statements on teacher formation, mentorship culture, and faculty professional development in classical pedagogy. This would push Element 5 toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): While currently CLASSICAL, maintain and deepen parent-formation initiatives (e.g., book studies, parent seminars, family liturgy alignment) to reinforce the co-educator model and ensure durable alignment with classical aims.

ABSTRACT

Founders Classical Academy – Carrollton exhibits a strong classical orientation, particularly in School Purpose & Goal and in Curriculum content (liberal-arts emphasis, Latin, logic, philosophy, and classic literature) and in Parents & Community (parents as co-educators). The school also demonstrates elements of a classical pedagogy (Trivium-focused framing and technology-free classrooms) and maintains a community ethos with a headmaster-led faculty and student-life expectations. However, certain canonical elements of a fully classical school—explicit Great Books and Great Conversation language, explicit theological grounding, liturgical/community practices, and a clearly stated “living curriculum” faculty narrative—are less visible in the public-facing materials. On balance, FCA Carrollton sits in the CLASSICAL family in several respects but remains more accurately described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL across the six-category rubric, with clear opportunities to deepen theological integration, explicit Great Books pedagogy, and faculty-lifecycle narratives to reach full CLASSICAL status.

Note: Citations refer to the school materials and the classical-literature keyword lexicon used to ground this analysis. Key evidentiary references include the FCA Carrollton public-facing_text describing education rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness and forming virtuous citizens, the liberal-arts curriculum emphasis (Latin, logic, philosophy, classic literature), the Trivium-pedagogy framing, technology-free classrooms, and the stated partnership with parents as co-educators.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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